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Magnetic catheter

Abstract

A magnetic catheter is disclosed. The magnetic catheter comprises: a first fixed magnet which is coupled to the front end of a catheter tube; a guide rod of which one end is coupled to the front end of the catheter tube, and the other end protrudes to the front of the catheter tube by a predetermined length; a body which is provided with a drill tip on the front end thereof, and has formed therein an inner space in which the other end of the guide rod is positioned; and a first drive magnet which is coupled to the body along the outer peripheral surface of the body.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is a National Stage of International Application No. PCT/KR2020/019447 filed Dec. 30, 2020, claiming priority based on Korean Patent Application No. 10-2020-0011472 filed Jan. 31, 2020 and Korean Patent Application No. 10-2020-0071852 filed Jun. 12, 2020.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present invention relates to a magnetic catheter, and more particularly, to a magnetic catheter capable of implementing a collision mechanism for improving a tunneling treatment effect.

BACKGROUND ART

(3) A magnetic catheter may be driven by receiving a magnetic torque and a magnetic force by an external magnetic field generated by a magnetic driving system, and may be controlled remotely and precisely, so that the magnetic catheter has been applied to many regions, and research and development of the magnetic catheter has been performed.

(4) Representatively, there is a magnetic catheter applied to a treatment of cardiac arrhythmia, and a magnetic blood vessel treatment catheter for a treatment of blood vessels has been developed. In a case of the magnetic blood vessel treatment catheter, it is very important to perform a tunneling treatment function to break a hard-clogged blood vessel. A conventional magnetic catheter may perform a tunneling treatment such that a person pushes the magnetic catheter by using a hand or a linear slide mechanism on an outer side of a human body while a drill tip rotates.

(5) Such a magnetic catheter has a limitation in that the tunneling treatment may not be effectively performed because a force may not reach an end of the catheter when a lesion is located in a portion after passing through a complex blood vessel.

DISCLOSURE

Technical Problem

(6) The present invention provides a magnetic catheter capable of effectively removing a lesion within a tubular tissue of a human body.

Technical Solution

(7) According to the present invention, a magnetic catheter includes: a catheter tube; a coupling magnet coupled to a front end of the catheter tube; a guide rod having one end coupled to the front end of the catheter tube, and an opposite end protruding forward of the catheter tube by a predetermined length; a body formed therein with an inner space in which the opposite end of the guide rod is located, and provided at a front end thereof with a drill tip; and a drive magnet coupled to the body along an outer peripheral surface of the body.

(8) In addition, the drive magnet included in the magnetic catheter may have a cylindrical shape, and may be bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis of the body.

(9) In addition, the coupling magnet included in the magnetic catheter may have a cylindrical shape, and may be bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis of the catheter tube.

(10) In addition, the magnetic catheter may further include a spacer formed of a non-magnetic material and coupled to a rear end of the body.

(11) In addition, an inner passage may be formed inside the spacer included in the magnetic catheter, and the guide rod may be inserted into the inner passage, in which the opposite end of the guide rod may have a larger diameter than the inner passage.

(12) In addition, the magnetic catheter may further include a fixed magnet located in the inner space, fixedly coupled to the opposite end of the guide rod, and bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis of the guide rod, and the fixed magnet may be arranged such that a polarity of the fixed magnet, which is different from a polarity of the coupling magnet, faces the polarity of the coupling magnet.

(13) In addition, the coupling magnet included in the magnetic catheter may include: a first magnetic layer having a plate shape; and a second magnet layer having a plate shape, coupled to the first magnet layer, and arranged such that a polarity of the second magnet layer, which is different from a polarity of the first magnetic layer, faces the polarity of the first magnetic layer.

(14) In addition, the fixed magnet included in the magnetic catheter may include: a third magnetic layer having a plate shape; and a fourth magnet layer having a plate shape, coupled to the third magnet layer, and arranged such that a polarity of the fourth magnet layer, which is different from a polarity of the third magnetic layer, faces the polarity of the third magnetic layer.

(15) In addition, the magnetic catheter may further include an auxiliary magnet fixedly coupled to the body in a space between the drive magnet and the spacer, and formed therein with a third inner passage, and the auxiliary magnet may include: a fifth magnetic layer having a plate shape; and a sixth magnet layer having a plate shape, coupled to the fifth magnet layer, and arranged such that a polarity of the sixth magnet layer, which is different from a polarity of the fifth magnetic layer, faces the polarity of the fifth magnetic layer.

Advantageous Effects

(16) According to the present invention, the drill tip provided at the front end of the magnetic catheter may rotate and move in forward and rearward directions under the control of an external magnetic field, so that a lesion can be effectively removed by a collision between the drill tip and the lesion.

(17) In addition, according to the present invention, the drill tip may be driven under the control of the external magnetic field, so that a tunneling treatment can be effectively performed even when the magnetic catheter passes through a complex blood vessel.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view showing a magnetic catheter according to one embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 2 is a sectional view showing the magnetic catheter of FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B is a view showing a driving process of the magnetic catheter according to the embodiment of FIG. 1.

(4) FIGS. 4 and 5 are sectional views showing a magnetic catheter according to another embodiment of the present invention.

(5) FIG. 6 is a view showing a magnetic catheter according to still another embodiment of the present invention.

(6) FIG. 7 is a sectional view showing the magnetic catheter according to still another embodiment of the present invention.

BEST MODE

(7) According to the present invention, a magnetic catheter includes: a catheter tube; a coupling magnet coupled to a front end of the catheter tube; a guide rod having one end coupled to the front end of the catheter tube, and an opposite end protruding forward of the catheter tube by a predetermined length; a body formed therein with an inner space in which the opposite end of the guide rod is located, and provided at a front end thereof with a drill tip; and a drive magnet coupled to the body along an outer peripheral surface of the body.

MODE FOR INVENTION

(8) Hereinafter, exemplary embodiments of the present invention will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. However, the technical idea of the present invention is not limited to the embodiments described herein, but may be realized in different forms. The embodiments introduced herein are provided to sufficiently deliver the idea of the present invention to those skilled in the art so that the disclosed contents may become thorough and complete.

(9) When it is mentioned in the present disclosure that one element is on another element, it means that one element may be directly formed on another element, or a third element may be interposed between one element and another element. Further, in the drawings, thicknesses of films and regions are exaggerated for effective description of the technical contents.

(10) In addition, in various embodiments of the present disclosure, the terms such as first, second, and third are used to describe various elements, but the elements are not limited by the terms. The terms are used only to distinguish one element from another element. Therefore, an element mentioned as a first element in one embodiment may be mentioned as a second element in another embodiment. The embodiments described and illustrated herein include their complementary embodiments. Further, the term “and/or” used herein is used to include at least one of the elements enumerated before and after the term.

(11) As used herein, the terms of a singular form may include plural forms unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. Further, the terms such as “including” and “having” are intended to designate the presence of features, numbers, steps, elements, or combinations thereof described in the present disclosure, and shall not be construed to preclude any possibility of the presence or addition of one or more other features, numbers, steps, elements, or combinations thereof. In addition, the term “connection” used herein is used to include both indirect and direct connection of a plurality of elements.

(12) Further, in the following description of the present invention, detailed descriptions of known functions and configurations incorporated herein will be omitted when they may make the gist of the present invention unnecessarily unclear.

(13) FIG. 1 is a perspective view showing a magnetic catheter according to one embodiment of the present invention, and FIG. 2 is a sectional view showing the magnetic catheter of FIG. 1.

(14) Referring to FIGS. 1 and 2, a magnetic catheter **10** may include a catheter tube **100**, a coupling magnet **110**, a guide rod **120**, a body **200**, a drive magnet **220**, and a spacer **230**.

(15) The catheter tube **100** may have a tube shape having a predetermined length, and may be formed of a flexible material that is deformable. A cross section of the catheter tube **100**, which is perpendicular to a longitudinal direction, may have a circular shape, a polygonal shape, or the like. The catheter tube **100** may be formed of a non-magnetic material, and may be inserted into a tubular tissue.

(16) The coupling magnet **110** may be coupled to a front end of the catheter tube **100**. The coupling magnet **110** may be a cylindrical magnet, and may be bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis of the catheter tube **100**.

(17) The guide rod **120** may have one end coupled to the front end of the catheter tube **100**, and an opposite end protruding forward of the catheter tube **100** by a predetermined length. The one end of the guide rod **120** may be inserted into an inner space of the coupling magnet **110**. The guide rod **120** may be formed of a non-magnetic material. The guide rod **120** may be inserted into a first inner passage **221** and a second inner passage **231**, and the opposite end of the guide rod **120** may be located in the inner space **201**. A body part of the guide rod **120** may have a smaller diameter than the first inner passage **221** and the second inner passage **231**, and the opposite end of the guide rod **120** may have a larger diameter than the second inner passage **231**.

(18) The body **200** may be located on a front side of the coupling magnet **110**. The body **200** may have a cylindrical shape having a predetermined diameter, and may be provided at a front end thereof with a drill tip **210**. The body **200** may be formed of a non-magnetic material. An inner

space **201** may be formed inside the body **200**.

(19) The drive magnet **220** may be provided along an outer peripheral surface of the body **200**, and may be fixedly coupled to the body **200**. The drive magnet **220** may be formed therein with the first inner passage **221**, and may have the same diameter as the body **200**. The drive magnet **220** may be a cylindrical magnet, and may be bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis of the body **200**.

(20) The spacer **230** may have a disc shape having a predetermined thickness, and may be fixedly coupled to a rear end of the body **200**. The spacer **230** may be formed of a non-magnetic material. A diameter of the space **230** may be equal to a diameter of the body **200**. A second inner passage **231** may be formed in the spacer **230**. The spacer **230** may block the drive magnet **220** and the coupling magnet **110** from being directly coupled by a magnetic force.

(21) FIG. **3** is a view showing a driving process of the magnetic catheter according to the embodiment of FIG. **1**.

(22) Referring to FIG. **3**, a rotating magnetic field **20** may be applied from an outside. The rotating magnetic field **20** may rotate about the central axis of the body **200**. According to the present embodiment, an example in which the rotating magnetic field **20** rotates in a counterclockwise direction will be described. FIG. **3(A)** shows an operation process of the magnetic catheter **10** while the rotating magnetic field **20** rotates from a $-y$ axis direction to a $+y$ axis direction. FIG. **3(B)** shows an operation process of the magnetic catheter **10** while the rotating magnetic field **20** rotates from the $+y$ axis direction to the $-y$ axis direction.

(23) Referring to FIG. **3(A)**, the drive magnet **220** may be aligned in the $+y$ axis direction according to the rotating magnetic field **20**, and in this process, the body **200** may rotate together with the drive magnet **220**. The drive magnet **220** aligned in the $+y$ axis direction may be arranged such that a polarity of the drive magnet **220**, which is different from a polarity of a fixed magnet **240**, faces the polarity of the fixed magnet **240**, and an attractive force may be generated between the drive magnet **220** and the fixed magnet **240**. Due to the attractive force, the body **200** may move in a $-x$ axis direction along the guide rod **120**.

(24) Referring to FIG. **3(B)**, the drive magnet **220** may be aligned in the $-y$ axis direction according to the rotating magnetic field **20**, and in this process, the body **200** may rotate together with the drive magnet **220**. The drive magnet **220** aligned in the $-y$ axis direction may be arranged such that the polarity of the drive magnet **220**, which is the same as the polarity of the fixed magnet **240**, faces the polarity of the fixed magnet **240**, and a repulsive force may be generated between the drive magnet **220** and the fixed magnet **240**. Due to the repulsive force, the body **200** may move in a $+x$ axis direction along the guide rod **120**.

(25) As described above, under the control of the rotating magnetic field **20**, the body **200** may moves linearly in forward and rearward directions along the guide rod **120** while rotating according to the rotating magnetic field **20**, and in this process, the drill tip **210** provided at the front end of the body **200** may collide with a lesion within a blood vessel. As the rotating magnetic field **20** rotates repeatedly, the drill tip **210** may perform a drilling operation while colliding with the lesion multiple times.

(26) FIGS. **4** and **5** are sectional views showing a magnetic catheter according to another embodiment of the present invention.

(27) Referring to FIGS. **4** and **5**, the magnetic catheter **10** may further include a fixed magnet **240**. The fixed magnet **240** may be a cylindrical magnet, and may be located in the inner space **201**. The fixed magnet **240** may be coupled to the opposite end of the guide rod **120**. The fixed magnet **240** may be bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on the central axis of the guide rod **120**. The fixed magnet **240** may be arranged such that a polarity of the fixed magnet **240**, which is different from a polarity of the coupling magnet **110**, faces the polarity of the coupling magnet **110**.

(28) As described with reference to FIG. **3**, when the rotating magnetic field **20** is applied from the outside, the drive magnet **220** and the body **200** may rotate according to the rotating magnetic field

20. In addition, due to the rotation of the drive magnet **220**, attractive and repulsive forces may be generated between the drive magnet **220** and the fixed magnet **240**.

(29) When the drive magnet **220** is arranged as shown in FIG. 4, an attractive force may be generated between the coupling magnet **110** and the drive magnet **220**, and a repulsive force may be generated between the fixed magnet **240** and the drive magnet **220**. The repulsive force between the fixed magnet **240** and the drive magnet **220** may increase a linear movement force of the body **200** in the $-y$ axis direction.

(30) When the drive magnet **220** is arranged as shown in FIG. 5, a repulsive force may be generated between the coupling magnet **110** and the drive magnet **220**, and an attractive force may be generated between the fixed magnet **240** and the drive magnet **220**. The attractive force between the fixed magnet **240** and the drive magnet **220** may increase a linear movement force of the body **200** in the $+y$ axis direction.

(31) As described above, the fixed magnet **240** may be provided to increase a movement force of the body **200** in the forward and rearward directions, so that a collision force of the drill tip **210** with respect to the lesion may be increased.

(32) FIG. 6 is a view showing a magnetic catheter according to still another embodiment of the present invention, and FIG. 7 is a sectional view showing the magnetic catheter according to the embodiment of FIG. 6.

(33) Referring to FIGS. 6 and 7, the coupling magnet **110** may include a first magnet layer **111** and a second magnet layer **112**.

(34) The first magnet layer **111** may have a plate shape, and may be bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis thereof.

(35) The second magnet layer **112** may have a plate shape having the same diameter as the first magnet layer **111**, and may be bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis thereof. The second magnet layer **112** may be fixedly coupled to the first magnet layer **111**, and may be arranged such that a polarity of the second magnet layer **112**, which is different from a polarity of the first magnet layer **111**, faces the polarity of the first magnet layer **111**. The polarity of the second magnet layer **112** may have the same area as the polarity of the first magnet layer **111**. Accordingly, a magnetic moment value of the coupling magnet **110** in which the first magnet layer **111** and the second magnet layer **112** are coupled to each other may be zero. In addition, a magnetic field direction of the coupling magnet **110** may be formed in a central axis direction thereof by the above structure.

(36) The fixed magnet **240** may include a third magnet layer **241** and a fourth magnet layer **242**.

(37) The third magnet layer **241** may have a plate shape, and may be bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis thereof.

(38) The fourth magnet layer **242** may have a plate shape having the same diameter as the third magnet layer **241**, and may be bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis thereof. The fourth magnet layer **242** may be fixedly coupled to the third magnet layer **241**, and may be arranged such that a polarity of the fourth magnet layer **242**, which is different from a polarity of the third magnet layer **241**, faces the polarity of the third magnet layer **241**. The polarity of the fourth magnet layer **242** may have the same area as the polarity of the third magnet layer **241**. Accordingly, a magnetic moment value of the fixed magnet **240** in which the third magnet layer **241** and the fourth magnet layer **242** are coupled to each other may be zero. In addition, a magnetic field direction of the fixed magnet **240** may be formed in a central axis direction thereof by the above structure.

(39) The magnetic catheter **10** may further include an auxiliary magnet **250**. The auxiliary magnet **250** may be located in a space between the drive magnet **220** and the spacer **230**, and may be formed therein with a third inner passage **253**. The auxiliary magnet **250** may include a fifth magnet layer **251** and a sixth magnet layer **252**.

(40) The fifth magnet layer **251** may have a plate shape, and may be bisected into an N-pole and an

S-pole based on a central axis thereof.

(41) The sixth magnet layer **252** may have a plate shape having the same diameter as that of the fifth magnet layer **251**, and may be bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis thereof. The sixth magnet layer **252** may be fixedly coupled to the fifth magnet layer **251**, and may be arranged such that a polarity of the sixth magnet layer **252**, which is different from a polarity of the fifth magnet layer **251**, faces the polarity of the fifth magnet layer **251**. The polarity of the sixth magnet layer **252** may have the same area as the polarity of the fifth magnet layer **251**.

Accordingly, a magnetic moment value of the auxiliary magnet **250** in which the sixth magnet layer **252** and the fifth magnet layer **251** are coupled to each other may be zero. In addition, a magnetic field direction of the auxiliary magnet **250** may be formed in a central axis direction thereof by the above structure.

(42) The coupling magnet **110**, the drive magnet **220**, and the auxiliary magnet **250** may be magnetized in the central axis directions thereof due to the above-described arrangements of the magnet layers. When the second magnet layer **112** and the fifth magnet layer **251** are arranged such that the polarity of the second magnet layer **112**, which is different from the polarity of the fifth magnet layer **251**, faces the polarity of the fifth magnet layer **251**, a magnetic field may be generated in a central axis direction of the guide rod **120**. A force of the body **200** moving toward the catheter tube **100** in a direction of the magnetic field may be further increased.

(43) When the second magnet layer **112** and the fifth magnet layer **251** are arranged such that the polarity of the second magnet layer **112**, which is the same as the polarity of the fifth magnet layer **251**, faces the polarity of the fifth magnet layer **251**, a magnetic field may be generated in the central axis direction of the guide rod **120**. A force of the body **200** moving forward of the catheter tube **100** in the direction of the magnetic field may be further increased.

(44) Although the exemplary embodiments of the present invention have been described in detail above, the scope of the present invention is not limited to a specific embodiment, and should be interpreted by the appended claims. In addition, it should be understood by those of ordinary skill in the art that various changes and modifications can be made without departing from the scope of the present invention.

INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

(45) The magnetic catheter according to the present invention may be used to remove a lesion within a tubular tissue of a human body.

Claims

1. A magnetic catheter comprising: a catheter tube; a coupling magnet coupled to a front end of the catheter tube; a guide rod having one end coupled to the front end of the catheter tube, and an opposite end protruding forward of the catheter tube by a predetermined length; a body having an inner space in which the opposite end of the guide rod is located, and provided at a front end thereof with a drill tip; a fixed magnet located in the inner space, fixedly coupled to the opposite end of the guide rod, and bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis of the guide rod; and a drive magnet coupled to the body along an outer peripheral surface of the body and disposed between the coupling magnet and the fixed magnet, wherein the fixed magnet is arranged such that a polarity of the fixed magnet, which is different from a polarity of the coupling magnet, faces the polarity of the coupling magnet.

2. The magnetic catheter of claim 1, wherein the drive magnet has a cylindrical shape, and is bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis of the body.

3. The magnetic catheter of claim 1, wherein the coupling magnet has a cylindrical shape, and is bisected into an N-pole and an S-pole based on a central axis of the catheter tube.

4. The magnetic catheter of claim 1, further comprising a spacer formed of a non-magnetic material and coupled to a rear end of the body.

5. The magnetic catheter of claim 4, wherein an inner passage is formed inside the spacer, and the guide rod is inserted into the inner passage, in which the opposite end of the guide rod has a larger diameter than the inner passage.
6. The magnetic catheter of claim 4, further comprising an auxiliary magnet fixedly coupled to the body in a space between the drive magnet and the spacer, and formed therein with a third inner passage, wherein the auxiliary magnet includes: a fifth magnetic layer having a plate shape; and a sixth magnet layer having a plate shape, coupled to the fifth magnet layer, and arranged such that a polarity of the sixth magnet layer, which is different from a polarity of the fifth magnetic layer, faces the polarity of the fifth magnetic layer.
7. The magnetic catheter of claim 1, wherein the coupling magnet includes: a first magnetic layer having a plate shape; and a second magnet layer having a plate shape, coupled to the first magnet layer, and arranged such that a polarity of the second magnet layer, which is different from a polarity of the first magnetic layer, faces the polarity of the first magnetic layer.
8. The magnetic catheter of claim 7, wherein the fixed magnet includes: a third magnetic layer having a plate shape; and a fourth magnet layer having a plate shape, coupled to the third magnet layer, and arranged such that a polarity of the fourth magnet layer, which is different from a polarity of the third magnetic layer, faces the polarity of the third magnetic layer.
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